

Digital Ad Sales and Revenue Reporting SOP - MCN News

Purpose

This document defines how the Ad Sales team packages and sells MCN News's digital ad inventory across platforms, and the revenue reporting cadence to Finance and Desk Editors.

Ad Inventory Types

MCN News sells four ad slot types, each with different packaging rules:

- Display banner: sold by impressions, available on web and mobile app only.
- Native article: sold as a flat placement fee per article slot per day, available on web, mobile app, and Facebook.
- Video pre-roll: sold by impressions (CPM), available on web, mobile app, Instagram, and X - the highest-CPM inventory type, reserved for video/live-blog content.
- Newsletter sponsorship: sold as a flat fee per newsletter send, one sponsor slot per edition, exclusive (not sold alongside another sponsor in the same send).

Platform-Specific Packaging

- Web and mobile app inventory is sold directly by Ad Sales against MCN News's own rate card, reviewed quarterly.
- Social platform inventory (Facebook, Instagram, X) is sold only as part of a bundled cross-platform package, never standalone - a social-only buy is redirected to a bundled package proposal, since social reach without owned-platform inventory underperforms MCN News's benchmark for advertiser renewal.
- Newsletter sponsorship is capped at 2 bookings per sponsor per month, to avoid reader fatigue from a repeat sponsor in a low-frequency format.

Booking and Reporting Process

1. Advertiser (directly or via agency) submits inventory type, platform(s), flight dates, and budget to Ad Sales.
2. Ad Sales confirms availability against the current booking calendar and issues a confirmation within 2 business days; creative assets are due 3 business days before flight start for a standards review (no separate compliance SOP exists for digital ad creative - Ad Sales applies MCN Group's general advertising standards).
3. Impressions-based bookings (display banner, video pre-roll) are trafficked against a daily delivery pace to avoid under- or over-delivering the contracted impression volume before the flight ends.

Revenue Reporting Cadence

Ad Sales publishes a daily revenue-by-platform-and-slot-type report to Finance, and a weekly summary to Desk Editors showing which desks' content is driving the most ad revenue by platform - used as one input (not the only one) to editorial resourcing discussions, alongside the

Editorial Review and Fact-Checking SOP's own quality standards, which are never relaxed for revenue reasons.